Earth and Planets · Staff Answers

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Arrival Answers

1. Approximately spherical (spheres).
2. The Earth orbits the Sun.
3. The Moon.
4. Yes. You can ask or pass.

Starter & Hinge Answers

Starter: A. The Sun's gravitational pull holds the moving planets in elliptical (nearly circular) orbits.

Hinge: A. Earth is a planet orbiting the Sun; the Moon is a natural satellite orbiting the Earth.

Evidence Desk Cards

Mercury, Venus, Earth, and Mars: Inner rocky planets: all four are roughly spherical and orbit the Sun.

Jupiter and Saturn: Outer gas giants: much larger than Earth and orbit further from the Sun.

Uranus and Neptune: Outer ice giants: take many Earth years to complete one orbit of the Sun.

The Sun at the centre of the solar system: Star: the Sun's gravity keeps all eight planets in orbit around it.

The Moon: Natural satellite: orbits the Earth in about

28 days and reflects sunlight.

The Sun orbits around a stationary flat Earth: Misconception: Earth is a sphere that rotates and orbits the Sun.

Check & Repair Answer

Only stars like the Sun make their own light; the Moon is a rocky satellite orbiting Earth that reflects sunlight.

Exit Ticket Answers

1. Approximately spherical (sphere). 2. Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars. 3. The Earth orbits the Sun (in 1 year / 365 days), and the Moon orbits the Earth (in about 28 days).